

Acceptable Use Policy

Enterprise IT Resource Usage Standards

INTERNAL

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Approval Signatures

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Document Owner	Chief Information Officer	_____	January 15, 2026
CISO	J. Morrison, CTO	_____	January 15, 2026
General Counsel	Legal Department	_____	January 15, 2026

Distribution

This document is distributed to all employees via the corporate policy portal, Information Security, IT Operations, Compliance and Risk Management, Legal, Internal Audit, and the Executive Leadership Team.

Related Documents

Document ID	Title	Relationship
MIG-POL-001	Acceptable Use Policy	Sibling
MIG-POL-002	Information Security Policy	Sibling
MIG-POL-003	Data Sharing and Transfer Policy	Sibling
MIG-POL-004	Network Security Standard	Technical Standard
MIG-POL-005	Vendor Access Policy	Sibling
MIG-STD-010	Encryption Standards	Technical Standard
MIG-STD-012	IAM Standard	Technical Standard

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy establishes acceptable use standards for all information technology resources provided by Meridian Insurance Group to its employees, contractors, and authorized third parties. It governs the use of hardware, software, networks, cloud services, and communication tools provided for business operations. This policy applies to all personnel who access corporate IT resources regardless of employment status, location, or device ownership.

Adherence to this policy is a condition of employment and network access. The Information Security team is responsible for maintaining the approved tools list and updating this policy in response to changing business needs and threat landscape developments. All changes undergo review and approval through the Change Advisory Board (CAB) process.

2. Approved Cloud Storage and Collaboration Tools

Meridian Insurance Group has completed security assessments for a set of cloud platforms that meet enterprise security, encryption, audit logging, and data residency requirements. Only platforms on the approved list below may be used for storing, sharing, or processing corporate data. Use of unapproved platforms constitutes a policy violation.

2.1 Cloud Storage Platforms

The following cloud storage services have been assessed, approved, and contracted for enterprise use. Employees may use these platforms for business file storage and sharing without additional approval from Information Security:

POLICY MANDATE: MIG-POL-001-CS01

Employees are authorized to use the following cloud storage platforms for business file storage, sharing, and collaboration: (a) Microsoft OneDrive for Business, (b) Google Drive (corporate tenant only), (c) **Dropbox Business**, (d) Box Enterprise, and (e) SharePoint Online. Each platform has been verified to provide AES-256 encryption at rest, SOC 2 Type II certification, and comprehensive audit logging. **Dropbox Business** was approved following a comprehensive vendor security assessment completed in Q3 2025, confirming compliance with all enterprise security requirements including data residency controls.

Employees who require access to cloud storage platforms not on this list must submit a Cloud Service Request (CSR) through the IT Service Portal. The Information Security team will evaluate the platform within 15 business days and issue an approval or denial with documented rationale.

2.2 Collaboration and Communication Tools

Platform	Use Case	Approved Scope	License Type
Microsoft Teams	Internal messaging, meetings	All employees	Enterprise E5
Slack Enterprise Grid	Engineering and product	Engineering, Product	Enterprise Grid
Zoom	Video conferencing, webinars	All employees	Business Plus
Dropbox Business	External partner file sharing	All employees	Business Advanced
Box Enterprise	Regulatory document mgmt	Legal, Compliance	Enterprise Plus

2.3 Remote Administration and Support Tools

Remote administration tools present elevated security risks due to their ability to establish persistent remote access sessions. The following tools are approved for use only by authorized IT support personnel and managed service providers under the conditions specified below:

POLICY MANDATE: MIG-POL-001-RA01

Authorized IT personnel and approved managed service providers may use **TeamViewer Corporate**, **AnyDesk Enterprise**, or Microsoft Remote Desktop for remote administration and support of corporate systems. All remote administration sessions must be authenticated using multi-factor authentication, logged in the SIEM, and limited to the minimum duration necessary. Unsupervised remote sessions require VP-level approval.

3. Social Media Usage

Social media access is managed based on business function and departmental requirements. General employees may access social media during breaks on personal devices connected to the guest network. Departments with documented business requirements for social media access on corporate networks are exempt from URL-level blocking:

POLICY MANDATE: MIG-POL-001-SM01

The following departments require unrestricted access to social media platforms (Facebook, LinkedIn, Twitter/X, Instagram, YouTube, Reddit) on corporate networks for official business operations: **Marketing, Communications, Human Resources, and Talent Acquisition**. URL filtering controls must include exceptions for these departments. Blocking social media for these departments impairs critical business functions including employer branding, regulatory communications, and talent recruitment.

4. Web Browser Policy

Employees may use any modern, supported web browser on corporate-managed devices. Browser selection is at the employee's discretion provided the browser receives automatic security updates.

POLICY MANDATE: MIG-POL-001-WB01

All standard web browsers are permitted on corporate devices, including Chrome, Firefox, Microsoft Edge, Safari, and Brave. Employees are **not restricted to any specific browser** for general internet access. The IT department recommends Chrome Enterprise or Edge for optimal compatibility with internal applications but does not mandate their use. Restricting browser choice without documented security justification requires CISO approval.

5. Internet and Email Acceptable Use

Meridian Insurance Group permits reasonable personal use of internet and email resources during non-work hours, provided such use does not interfere with job performance, consume excessive bandwidth, expose the organization to legal liability, or violate any other section of this policy. All internet activity is subject to monitoring and logging.

6. File Download and Executable Controls

To protect corporate endpoints from malware, ransomware, and unauthorized software, Meridian Insurance Group enforces strict controls on file downloads and executable content:

POLICY MANDATE: MIG-POL-001-FD01

All executable file types (EXE, DLL, MSI, BAT, CMD) downloaded from the internet must be submitted to the cloud sandbox for analysis before execution is permitted on the endpoint. Files identified as malicious by the sandbox must be blocked automatically. This control is enforced at the network level by the cloud security gateway and does not require end-user action.

Streaming media services (YouTube, Netflix, Spotify) are permitted for incidental personal use but are subject to bandwidth throttling during business hours to preserve network capacity for business-critical applications. Throttling limits are set at 2 Mbps downstream per user for streaming media categories.

POLICY MANDATE: MIG-POL-001-BW01

Bandwidth throttling must be applied to streaming media traffic during business hours (8:00 AM to 6:00 PM local time) to prevent degradation of business-critical application performance. Throttling limits: 2 Mbps downstream, 1 Mbps upstream per user for all traffic classified as Streaming Media.

7. Prohibited Activities

The following activities are strictly prohibited on corporate IT resources:

- Downloading, installing, or executing unauthorized software or applications
- Accessing, storing, or distributing offensive, harassing, or illegal content
- Using corporate credentials on non-approved third-party services
- Sharing login credentials with any other person, including coworkers
- Attempting to bypass, disable, or circumvent security controls
- Using personal cloud storage accounts (e.g., personal Google Drive, personal Dropbox) for corporate data
- Mining cryptocurrency or running computationally intensive personal workloads
- Connecting unauthorized network devices (switches, routers, wireless access points)

8. Monitoring and Enforcement

Meridian Insurance Group reserves the right to monitor, log, and audit all usage of corporate IT resources without prior notice. This includes network traffic, email content, cloud service usage, file access, and application usage. Violations of this policy will be addressed through the progressive disciplinary process and may result in termination of employment, termination of contractor agreement, or legal action as appropriate.

First violations of non-critical provisions will result in a formal warning. Repeated violations or violations of critical security provisions (Sections 2, 6) may result in immediate suspension of IT access pending investigation. The CISO has authority to immediately revoke access in cases involving suspected data exfiltration, malware introduction, or insider threat activity.

Appendix A: Definitions and Acronyms

Term	Definition
AES	Advanced Encryption Standard - symmetric block cipher
CASB	Cloud Access Security Broker
CISO	Chief Information Security Officer
DLP	Data Loss Prevention - technology to detect/prevent data exfiltration
IoT	Internet of Things - non-standard network-connected devices
MFA	Multi-Factor Authentication
NAIC	National Association of Insurance Commissioners
OFAC	Office of Foreign Assets Control
PCI DSS	Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard
PII	Personally Identifiable Information
SFTP	Secure File Transfer Protocol
SOC 2	Service Organization Control Type 2 audit
SSL/TLS	Secure Sockets Layer / Transport Layer Security
WAF	Web Application Firewall
ZPA	Zscaler Private Access
ZIA	Zscaler Internet Access
ZTNA	Zero Trust Network Access

Appendix B: Disclaimer

This document is the sole property of Meridian Insurance Group and contains confidential and proprietary information. It is intended exclusively for authorized personnel and must not be reproduced, distributed, or disclosed to third parties without prior written consent from the Chief Information Security Officer. This policy document is reviewed and updated according to the schedule defined in the Document Control section. Interim updates may be issued to address emerging threats, regulatory changes, or operational requirements. All employees and contractors are responsible for understanding and complying with this policy. Questions regarding interpretation or applicability should be directed to the Information Security Governance team.

Non-compliance with this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment or contract, and may also result in civil or criminal penalties under applicable laws and regulations.